

Canon VIXIA HG10

Ridiculously Priced

The Canon HG10 is a one of the few high-definition camcorders to run on a hard drive—40 GB, to be precise. The design is attractive and it looks a lot like most tape- and optical disc-based camcorders. Although slightly heavy, the HG10 is quite comfortable to hold and use for long periods. The HG10 records videos at a maximum resolution of 1440 x 1080. When it comes to performance, it does a decent job. It has a good zoom lens that goes up to 10x. There is little grain in bright areas and very fine grain in the dark areas. The frame rate is stable all throughout the video recording and the exposure meter works rather well. It is easy to go from low light to dark areas without a sudden jolt in exposures. There is also a powerful light that can be used in total darkness. The user interface is colourful and most of the controls for it are on the LCD screen. Movies and files can be copied and moved about freely without the need of bulky software. The camera uses a kind of AVC standard—AVCHD to record movies, so any media player capable of playing H.264 content can play them—VLC or Media Player Classic with ffdshow.



At Rs 89,995, it is a very costly camcorder for a home user to buy or even consider.

Specifications
1/2.7-inch CMOS Sensor, 10x optical zoom, still photo resolution: 2048x1536 (3.1 MP), 40 GB hard drive.

Contact: Canon India Pvt Ltd
Phone: 1-800-3453366
E-mail: info@canon.co.in
Web site: www.canon.co.in
Price: Rs 89,995

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★☆☆
Overall	★★★★★

3DPaintBrush

The Ultimate Utility For Architects

3DPaintBrush 1.0 is one of the latest products to come from the Indian software house—Geometric. The software is aimed at architects and those who want to demo models in a scene without having to set up lights in a 3D scene. Unlike professional 3D modelling software, there is no renderer to render a high quality frame and most of the rendering is done using DirectX as well. Basic modelling tools and texturing features are available too, and you can animate the camera as well. Shaders can be



set to objects and different lighting schemes can be used. One of the most unique features of 3DPaintBrush is 3DSnip. 3DSnip allows you to capture pretty much any

model from any 3D software into the program with a couple of clicks. Other features include importing models through the program from Google 3D Warehouse. There is also support for popular formats for programs such as 3D Studio Max and the widely used OBJ format. Without any models loaded, 3DPaintBrush hardly consumes 13 MB of RAM. There aren't any unnecessary features as such in the application.

At \$99 (Rs 4,150), it's amazingly well priced.

Specifications
Requirements: 1.2 GHz Processor, 512 MB Memory, 100 MB space DirectX 9.0c card, Windows XP and Vista supported

Contact: Geometric Ltd.
Phone: +91-22-67056880
E-mail: sales@3dpaintbrush.com
Web site: www.3dpaintbrush.com
Price: \$99 (Approx Rs 4,150)

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Ease of Use	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Creative MuVo T200

Simple, But A Tad Expensive

The Creative MuVo T200 is a compact little 2 GB MP3 player shaped like a USB Flash drive. It is aimed at users who want a compact and easy to use PMP for cheap.

It comes with a tiny colour screen, which looks decent. There are colour themes that you can switch to as well. The styling is average and the player comes with a smooth finish. The buttons aren't printed and are just moulded into the body.

The interface is a little confusing at first, but one gets used to in a few minutes.



There is voice recording and the player can tune in to radio as well. FM stations are auto scanned and can be stored as presets.

Performance issues are noticed when you fast forward and rewind tracks—it loses track of the position of the song and displays the wrong position.

The earplugs supplied with the player are of poor quality—the sound from them is very flat with highs over-emphasised.

With a price of Rs 3,399, it is definitely a bit expensive for a 2 GB MP3 player. PMPs with additional features and a better build are priced competitively.

Specifications
Dimensions: 25 x 77.7 x 11 mm, Weight: 20.6 gm, Memory: 2 GB, Formats supported: Built-in rechargeable Li-ion battery, USB 2.0 connectivity, FM radio

Contact: Creative Technology
Phone: +91-9821455590
E-mail: irfan@ctl.creative.com
Web site: http://in.creative.com
Price: Rs 3,399

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

LG KF600

Style Statement For Smaller Pockets

The KF600 is a brand new model from LG and seems to be influenced by the recently reviewed LG Viewty.

The KF600 has a small touch screen at the bottom that's called an InteractPad. Above that is the slightly larger screen as the main display.

Interacting with the KF600 gets a little irritating. Usually, a touch screen allows you to press the feature or button on the screen. The KF600 needs you to use directional buttons on a touch screen to navigate. It might seem like fun in the beginning but it gets annoying fast. The keypad has slightly clunky buttons, but the slide mechanism is smooth.



The phone's camera is decent and there are a lot

of features available in the photo shooting application. The image stabilisation works pretty well too. The software interface of the KF600 is similar to that of the Viewty. There are themes available which are very similar to each other just with different colors. There are a few decent games and a few applications as well.

Reception on the phone is good and so is the voice tone is very rounded. There are no harsh bits in the voice. The earphones supplied are average and not vibrant.

The KF600 is quite similar to the Viewty. At Rs 14,990, it is pretty expensive for a phone of this kind. Other than the

price, using the phone can get pretty annoying and the additional small touch screen robs the phone of a larger screen.

Specifications
Dimensions: 101.2 mm x 50.7 mm x 14.1 mm, Weight: 107 gms, MicroSD expansion slot, 800 mAh Li-ion battery

Contact: LG Electronics India Pvt. Ltd.
Phone: +91-120-2560900
E-mail: viveksingh@lgindia.com
Web site: www.lgindia.com
Price: Rs. 14,990

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★